



Research Proposal

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Research Proposal

- A research proposal is a document written for the purpose of obtaining funding for a research project.
- The research proposal includes information to convince the funding agency that the project is worthy of support and can be successfully implemented.

Components of a research proposal

A research proposal commonly follows the following format:

- ☐ Title page
- ☐ Project summary
- ☐ Project description
- ☐ Ethical considerations
- ☐ Timetable
- ☐ Problems anticipated
- ☐ Budget
- ☐ References
- ☐ Curriculum vitae of the investigator(s)

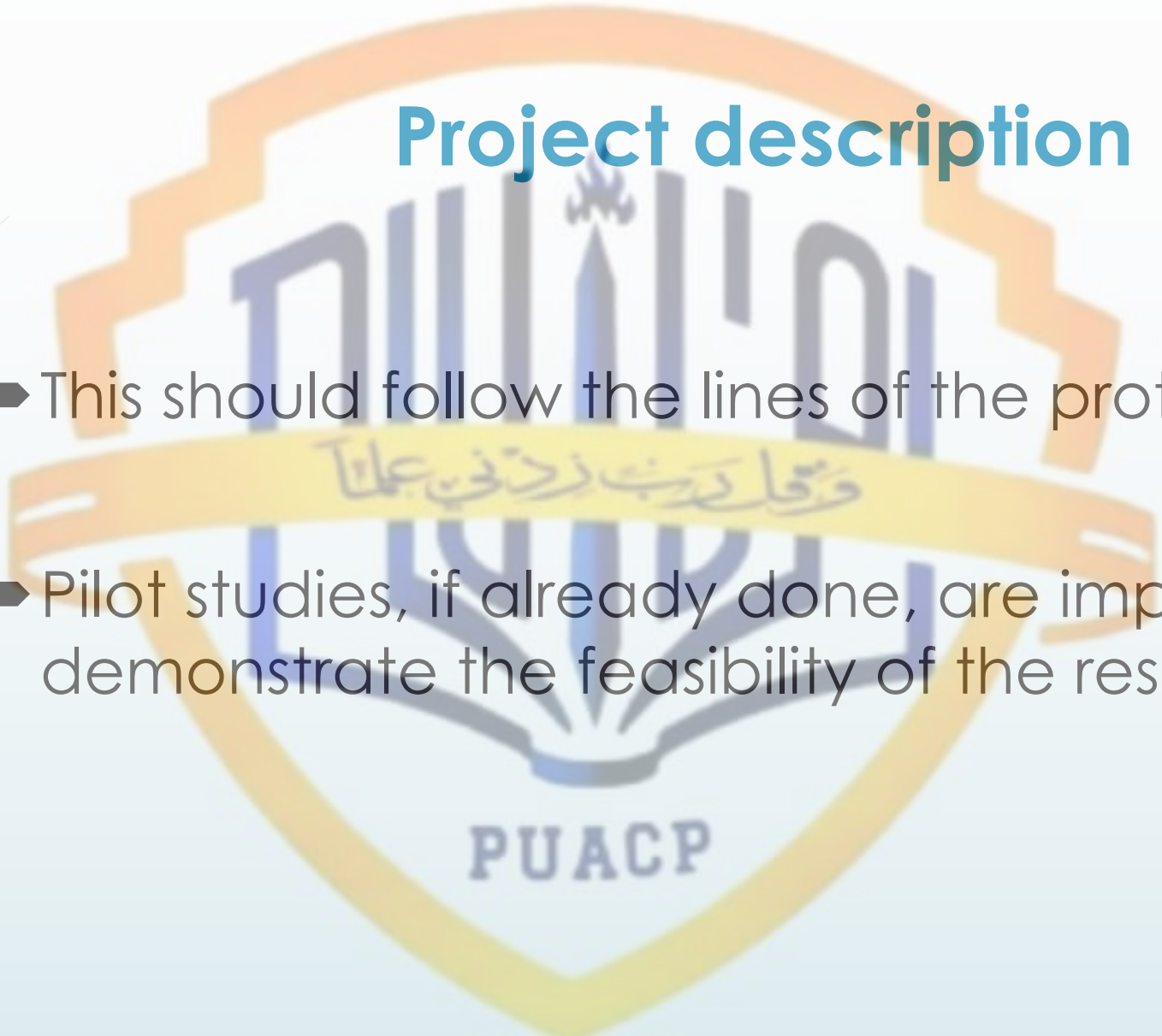
Title page

- This page should provide information on
 - Project title
 - Principal investigator(s)
 - Institution
 - Duration of the project
 - Funding requested



Project summary

- The project summary should be carefully written.
- It will be the first (and may be the only) part read by the reviewers.
- It should reveal the importance and the strengths of the project.



Project description

- This should follow the lines of the protocol
- Pilot studies, if already done, are important to demonstrate the feasibility of the research



Ethical considerations

- Approval from the local ethics review committee does not relieve the donor agency from the ethical responsibility for the project
- Also approval by a donor agency does not relieve the research institution from ethical responsibility for the project

Timetable

- The investigators should commit themselves to a timetable
- The timetable should estimate the duration for collection of data, final analysis of data and writing up the report
- In project proposals of a long duration (more than one year), the timetable should set milestones to be reached
- These are taken into consideration when progress reports are reviewed by the funding agency
- Funding is often released on the basis of these progress reports.

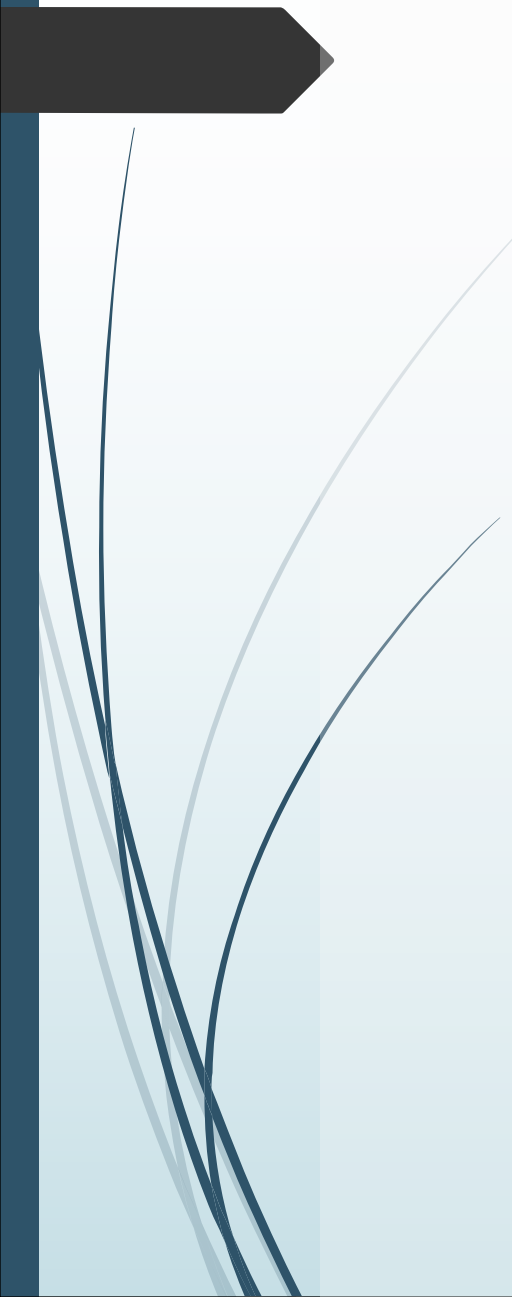
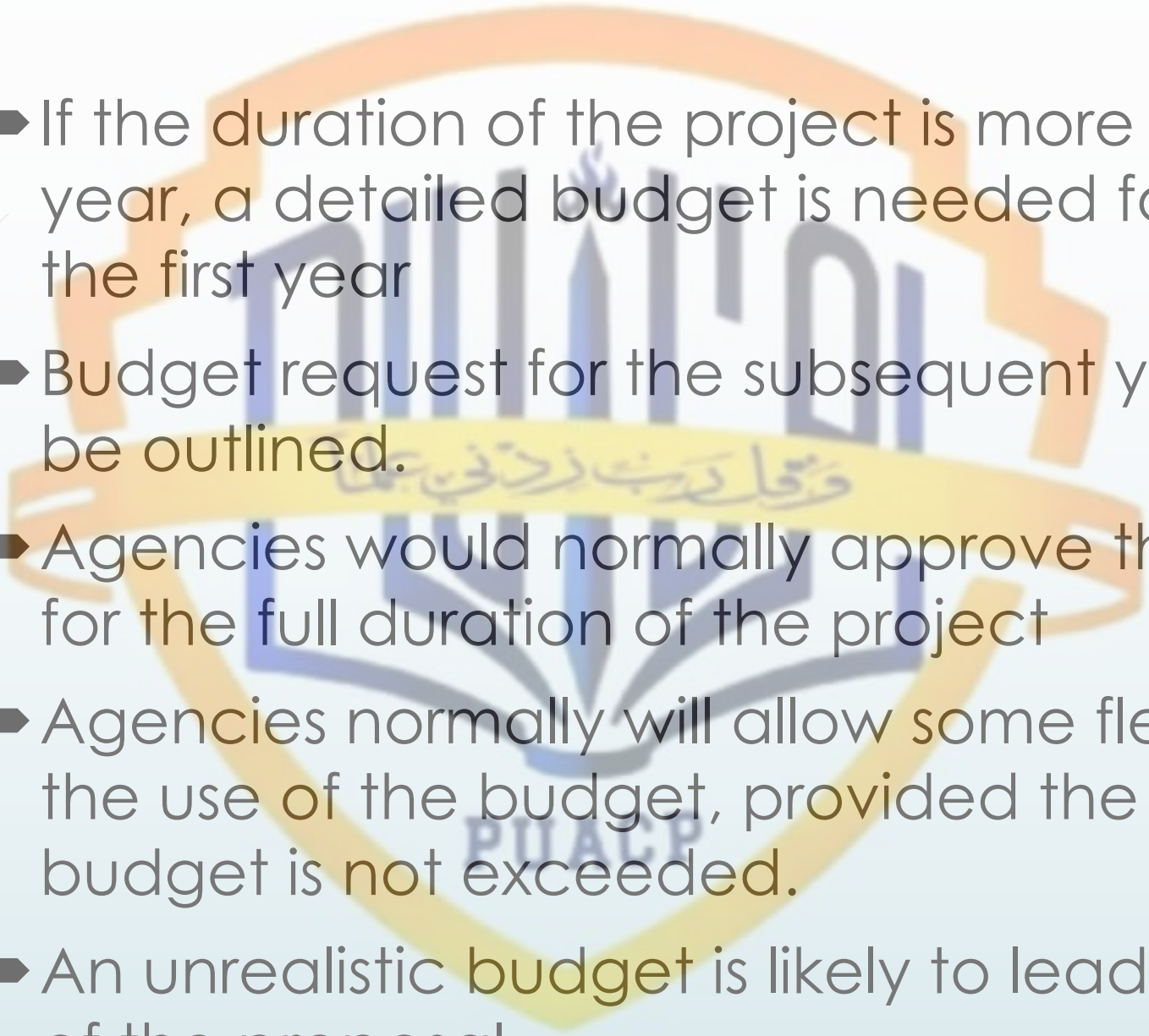


Problems anticipated

- The investigators should demonstrate their awareness of obstacles and difficulties, which may interfere with the successful completion of the project within the timeframe and cost proposed.
- They should explain how these obstacles and difficulties would be dealt with.
- An investigator who does not anticipate any problem probably has not thought out the details of the project carefully.

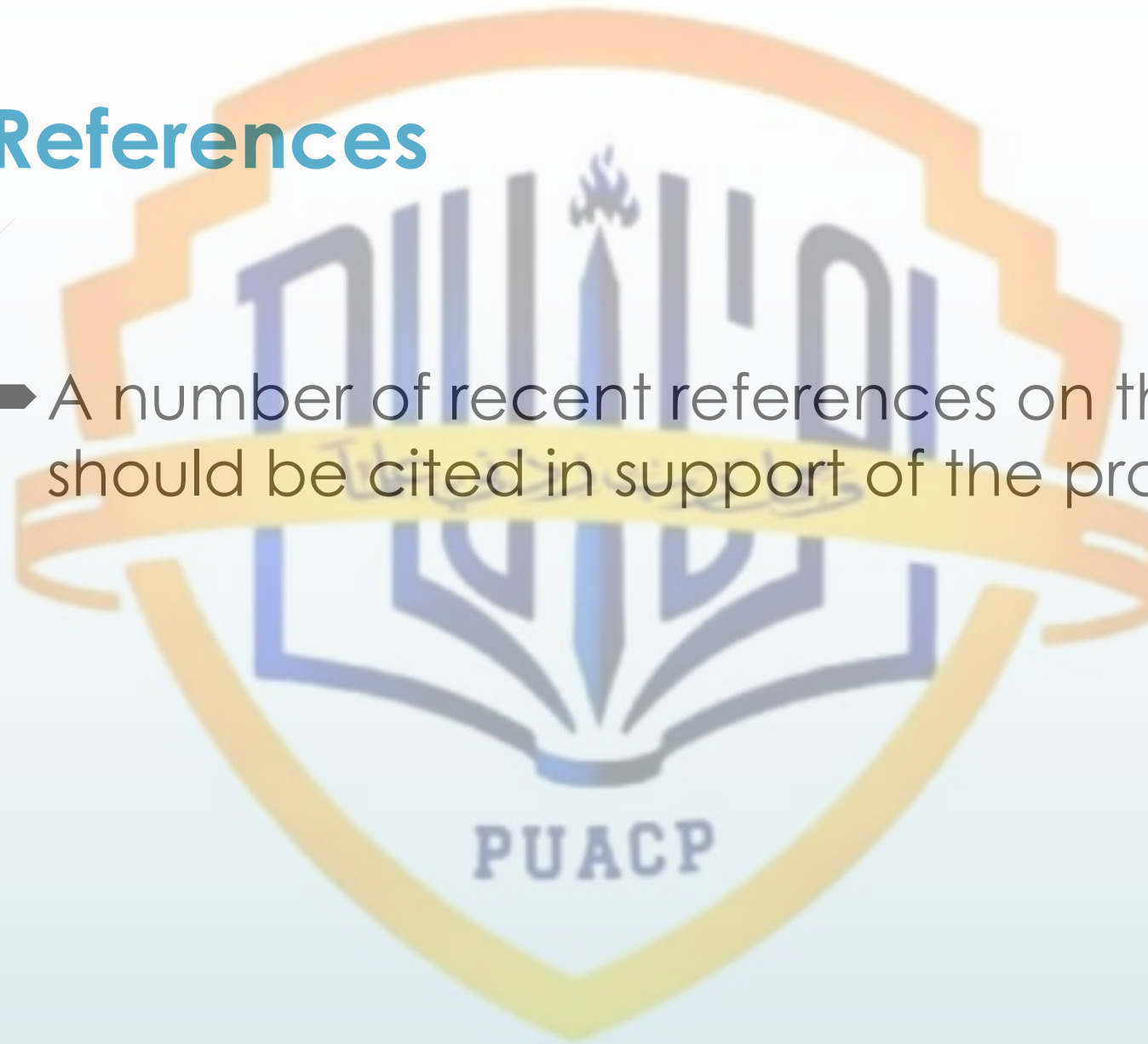
Budget

- The budget request should be itemized and each item should be justified
- The following are examples of categories of expenses
 - Personnel (names, positions, percentage of time spent on the project, salary)
 - Equipment
 - Supplies
 - Patient care costs
 - Travel
 - Data processing
 - Communications
 - Publication/dissemination of information about the outcome of the project.

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- If the duration of the project is more than one year, a detailed budget is needed for at least the first year
 - Budget request for the subsequent years should be outlined.
 - Agencies would normally approve the budget for the full duration of the project
 - Agencies normally will allow some flexibility in the use of the budget, provided the total budget is not exceeded.
 - An unrealistic budget is likely to lead to rejection of the proposal.

References

- A number of recent references on the subject should be cited in support of the proposal.



Thanx

